

Poetry Study





About the Course

Continuing in their poetry studies, students review a wide variety of poetic forms, learn how they have evolved over the centuries, and practice writing their own poems.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 9



Placement & Combining Tips

Prerequisite: Grade 8 Poetry Study or a working knowledge of poetic forms and terminology.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9	Poetry Study: Grade 9 2 times/week 15 min	The Making of a Poem

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 9				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 9		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Study: Grade 9	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Poetry Study: Grade 9



The Making of a Poem



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Poetry Study: Grade 9

How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read over the terms. Take a moment before reading to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Literature lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their ideas.

Poetry Study: Grade 9

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Term 1

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 1

The Villanelle

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

This book introduces several poetic forms. Many of you will already know. However, some will be new, and there are still more that time won't allow us to cover. The anthology takes us further into the history of how those forms developed over the centuries, each new generation of poets dialoguing with those in the past. Along the way, you will read many different examples of each form, and you'll write your own poems as well.

→ READ

- p.xiii "This book" - "single poetic form."
- p.3-7 "Overview", "The Villanelle At-a-Glance", and "The History of the Form"

→ NARRATE

- Jot down a few ideas from your reading.
- Read "The House on the Hill" by Edwin Arlington Robinson on p.9-10. Then look at p.5, "The Villanelle At-a-Glance", and see if you can identify each of the poetic features listed in Robinson's poem. You may want to highlight, underline, or color-code the different features you find to help you notice and remember.

• COMPOSITION ACTIVITY

Over the year, you'll create your own reference book for the various poetic forms you study. The purpose is for you to have a quick guide that makes sense to you and is easy to pull up or keep on hand as you read individual poems. Start by creating your own "At-a-Glance" for the Villanelle. Here are a few of the possibilities:

- Copy the "Villanelle At-a-Glance" into a designated space in a notebook or a document on a device where you can easily find and reference it in the future. Add any additional notes for yourself that you'd like.
- Draw an illustration or create an infographic in Canva (or similar design software) showing the form more visually.
- Create a PowerPoint and create your own Villanelle At-a-Glance for the first slide (using text and/or visuals).
- Something else! Get creative!

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 2

Reading Villanelles

Materials: The Making of a Poem, poetry notebook (opt.)

→ INTRO

Refresh your memory with the "Villanelle At-a-Glance" on p.5 and read the following villanelles aloud. Think about the following questions as you read. You may want to keep your poetry notebook nearby or write in the margins of your book to track your thinking.

- What words strike you?
- What lines sound particularly odd?
- What reactions do you have as you read?
- Do all these poets follow the "rules" for villanelles, or do they bend them a bit? Playing with rules is part of the poet's business.

Naturalist Jack Laws encourages us to view nature by asking ourselves, "What do I notice?", "What do I wonder?", and "What does this remind me of?" We can ask these same questions of stories and poems as well. Read these poems actively! Again, you may want to keep your poetry notebook nearby or write in the margins of your book to track your thinking as you read the next poems in this lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- p.11-12 "The Waking," "One Art," and "Do Not Go Gentle into That Good Night"
- p.14 "By the Sound"

Poetry Study: Grade 9

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Term 1

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 3

More Villanelles

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ

p.18 "Villanelle for the Middle of the Night"

p.19-20 "Close-up of a Villanelle"

∞ Article Link: Villanelle by Andrew Lang

∞ Article Link: A Dainty Thing's the Villanelle by W.E. Henley

→ DISCUSS

- Which of the villanelles that you've read is your favorite? Why?
- The villanelle has been called the "poetry of loss" because of the way the repeated lines can build an echo of sadness. However, as you previously read, the villanelle originated from lighter ballads and songs and has also been used for lighter and happier topics (several of the ones you read today). What topics do you think the villanelle fits best?

• COMPOSITION

Start writing your own villanelle. Refer to your At-a-Glance guide and the villanelles you have read as needed.

Reference: Making of a Poem

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 4

The Sestina

Materials: The Making of a Poem, copies of poems (opt.)

→ INTRO

You'll read a variety of sestinas over the next few lessons. Sestinas are a pretty complicated poetic form (they show the poet/singer's mastery!), so it's ok if it takes a bit of time to make sense of the patterns. You may want to print off some of the poems or mark them up in your book to help you notice the various features of the genre (along with your other thoughts).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.21-24 "The Sestina At-a-Glance," "The History of the Form," "The Contemporary Context"

→ READ

Read the poem aloud to better hear the words since it is from the 1500s and the spelling is not the same as today (Edmund Spenser is a famous English poet from that time).

p.25-26 "Ye wastefull woodes, bear witness of my woe"

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 5

Reading Sestinas

Materials: The Making of a Poem, digital or physical notebook

→ INTRO

Read the following poems aloud once to simply enjoy the sound of the words and get the sense of the poem. Then read the poems again, looking more closely at the formal features of the poetry (pay special attention to the last words of each line, and watch the pattern). Finally, write questions or thoughts in your book or notebook.

→ READ & NARRATE

p.29 "Sestina: Of the Lady Pietra degli Scrovigni (translation; the original is written in Italian by Dante Alighieri, who wrote the Divine Comedy)

p.30-31 "Sestina"

→ CREATE

Start creating your own "Sestina At-a-Glance" page for your reference guide in your digital or physical medium of choice.

Poetry Study: Grade 9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 6

More Sestinas

Materials: The Making of a Poem, digital or physical notebook used in the previous lesson

→ CREATE

Take a few minutes to finish creating your "Sestina At-a-Glance" page in your reference guide.

→ READ

p.32-35 "Sestina," "Sestina of the Tramp-Royal," and "Sestina: Altaforte"

(Note that part of the context for "Altaforte" is the poet imagining what a man known for stirring up strife might say. The man is based on a character in Dante's longer epic poem, the Divine Comedy, who was put in hell for stirring up strife).

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

How would you describe the energy and emotion in each of the poems from today?